

Daily Content Intel

July 29, 2026

Topic A — Reel

TELEPROMPTER COPY (paste into Instagram)

Okay, if you've torn a hamstring, somebody has probably told you that leg is different now, that it won't respond the way it used to, and that you're going to be managing it forever.

A new study out of Dublin says something else. 26 elite under-20 Gaelic football players, 9 weeks into their competitive season, one lifting session a week. 2 sets of 4 Nordic hamstring curls, and 3 sets of 6 staggered stance Romanian deadlifts. That's the whole hamstring program.

After 9 weeks the long head of the biceps femoris got longer, about 0.31 centimeters of fascicle length on

average. And the limbs that had already been injured in the last year changed just as much as the limbs that had never been hurt.

The honest part is that eccentric strength didn't move. So once a week is probably enough to change the architecture of the muscle, and it's probably not enough to build strength. If strength is the goal, you need more than that.

So Monday: 2 sets of 4 Nordics, 3 sets of 6 staggered stance RDLs, once a week, all season, and keep sprinting, because these guys were running full speed in training and matches the whole time.

Your old hamstring injury doesn't lock you out of adapting.

Be Good. Help Someone. Learn Lots.

Hook: If you've torn a hamstring before, that hamstring can still change just as much as everybody else's.

Spoken script (word for word):

Okay, if you've torn a hamstring, somebody has probably told you that leg is different now, that it won't respond the way it used to, and that you're going to be managing it forever.

A new study out of Dublin says something else. 26 elite under-20 Gaelic football players, 9 weeks into their competitive season, one lifting session a week. 2 sets of 4 Nordic hamstring curls, and 3 sets of 6 staggered stance Romanian deadlifts. That's the whole hamstring program.

After 9 weeks the long head of the biceps femoris got longer, about 0.31 centimeters of fascicle length on average. And the limbs that had already been injured in the last year changed just as much as the limbs that had never been hurt.

The honest part is that eccentric strength didn't move. So once a week is probably

enough to change the architecture of the muscle, and it's probably not enough to build strength. If strength is the goal, you need more than that.

So Monday: 2 sets of 4 Nordics, 3 sets of 6 staggered stance RDLs, once a week, all season, and keep sprinting, because these guys were running full speed in training and matches the whole time.

Your old hamstring injury doesn't lock you out of adapting.

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On-screen text seeds:

- 0:00 "That leg is different now" is what you were told
- 0:08 26 elite U20 footballers, 9 weeks, in season
- 0:18 2x4 Nordics + 3x6 staggered stance RDL, 1x/week
- 0:30 Fascicle length +0.31 cm
- 0:40 Previously injured limbs adapted the same
- 0:52 Eccentric strength did not change

- 1:05 Architecture moved. Strength needs more volume.
- 1:15 Keep sprinting

Caption (copy-paste ready):

A past hamstring tear does not lock your hamstring out of adapting.

26 elite under-20 Gaelic football players trained one hamstring session a week for the first 9 weeks of their season. 2 sets of 4 Nordic hamstring curls, 3 sets of 6 staggered stance Romanian deadlifts. That was the whole program.

Biceps femoris long head fascicle length went up about 0.31 cm. The limbs that had been injured in the last 12 months changed just as much as the limbs that never got hurt.

Eccentric strength did not budge, so treat one session a week as an architecture dose, not a strength dose. If strength is the goal, add volume.

The athletes were sprinting in training and matches the whole time. Speed exposure is part of the prescription.

It's time to cross your threshold.

Dr. Lars Stevenson, PT, DPT
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#hamstring #nordichamstring
#footballtraining #lacrosse
#highschoolfootball
#strengthenandconditioning #returntosport
#sportsrehab #speedtraining
#athletedevelopment #physicaltherapy
#inseasontraining

Personalize this

- Which of your HS football or lacrosse guys came back from a hamstring pull and still trains like that leg is fragile? Name what he can do now that he could not do in the spring, without naming him.
- What is your actual in-season hamstring dose for a Threshold athlete (sets, reps, and which day relative to game day), and how does it differ from this study's once-a-week minimum?
- Where does a previous hamstring injury sit in your CROSS framework, and what do you use as the green light before you

turn a midfielder loose at full speed again?

Screenshots:

- title | <https://pmc.ncbi.nlm.nih.gov/articles/PMC13297019/> | "Previous Hamstring Injury Does Not Impact Biceps Femoris Long Head Fascicle Length"
- physiology | <https://pmc.ncbi.nlm.nih.gov/articles/PMC13297019/> | "These findings suggest changes to BFlh fascicle length and eccentric knee flexion strength from baseline to follow-up were comparable across all limb-types"
- actionable | <https://pmc.ncbi.nlm.nih.gov/articles/PMC13297019/> | "Participants performed two sets of four Nordic hamstring exercise (NHE) repetitions and three sets of six"

Sources:

- <https://pmc.ncbi.nlm.nih.gov/articles/PMC13297019/>
- <https://doi.org/10.1002/ejsc.70204>

Topic B — Reel

TELEPROMPTER COPY (paste into Instagram)

Okay, hot take. That preseason movement screen score is the most useless number in a high school athletic program.

New prospective study, June 2026, university basketball players, followed for a year. They ran the standard 7-part screen, they used the classic cutoff of 14 or below, and then they waited to see who actually got hurt. Sensitivity of 0.38, specificity of 0.61, area under the curve of 0.52. That's a coin flip.

And in high school football, lacrosse, and baseball players, an earlier study found the same thing, where neither the total score nor the individual pieces flagged who was going to get injured.

Here's the part I'll defend. The individual patterns did carry signal in this study,

the deep squat and the hurdle step specifically, and when the researchers weighted the items instead of just adding them up, the prediction got better. So the movements are worth watching, and the single number on the clipboard is worth kind of ignoring.

What actually moves injury risk in my athletes is training history, previous injury, how much high speed running they've banked, and how strong they are. Screen if you like screening. Just don't hand an athlete a 15 and call them safe.

Be Good. Help Someone. Learn Lots.

Hook: The preseason movement screen score is the most useless number in a high school athletic program.

Spoken script (word for word):

Okay, hot take. That preseason movement screen score is the most useless number in

a high school athletic program.

New prospective study, June 2026, university basketball players, followed for a year. They ran the standard 7-part screen, they used the classic cutoff of 14 or below, and then they waited to see who actually got hurt. Sensitivity of 0.38, specificity of 0.61, area under the curve of 0.52. That's a coin flip.

And in high school football, lacrosse, and baseball players, an earlier study found the same thing, where neither the total score nor the individual pieces flagged who was going to get injured.

Here's the part I'll defend. The individual patterns did carry signal in this study, the deep squat and the hurdle step specifically, and when the researchers weighted the items instead of just adding them up, the prediction got better. So the movements are worth watching, and the single number on the clipboard is worth kind of ignoring.

What actually moves injury risk in my athletes is training history, previous injury, how much high speed running they've

banked, and how strong they are. Screen if you like screening. Just don't hand an athlete a 15 and call them safe.

Be Good. Help Someone. Learn Lots.

On-screen text seeds:

- 0:00 The screen score does not tell you who gets hurt
- 0:09 June 2026, university athletes, tracked 1 year
- 0:20 Cutoff of 14 or below: AUC 0.52
- 0:28 Sensitivity 0.38 / Specificity 0.61
- 0:36 Same result in HS football and lacrosse players
- 0:48 Individual patterns did carry signal
- 1:00 Weighted items: AUC 0.75
- 1:10 Watch the movement. Ignore the number.

Caption (copy-paste ready):

The preseason movement screen score is close to useless for predicting injury.

June 2026 prospective cohort, university basketball players followed for a year. The

classic total-score cutoff of 14 or below produced a sensitivity of 0.38, a specificity of 0.61, and an area under the curve of 0.52. That is a coin flip.

An earlier study in high school football, lacrosse, and baseball players found neither the composite score nor the individual task scores predicted lower extremity injury.

The nuance worth keeping: individual patterns did carry signal here (deep squat and hurdle step), and weighting the items instead of summing them lifted prediction to an AUC of 0.75. Watch the movement. Stop trusting the total.

What actually moves risk: training history, previous injury, accumulated high speed running, and strength.

It's time to cross your threshold.

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#movementscreen #injuryprevention
#highschoolfootball #lacrosse
#strengthandconditioning
#sportsphysicaltherapy #athletedevelopment

#preseason #returntosport #coaching
#sportsscience #physicaltherapy

Personalize this

- What do you actually run on a new Threshold athlete instead of a 7-part screen, and what has a deep squat or hurdle step told you that changed the first block you wrote?
- Tell the story of an athlete who screened clean and got hurt anyway, or screened badly and never missed a day. What did you learn about what the screen was missing?
- A parent or a HS coach hands you a screen score sheet and asks who is at risk. What is your answer, and what 3 things do you ask for instead (training history, prior injury, sprint exposure, strength numbers)?

Screenshots:

- title | <https://pmc.ncbi.nlm.nih.gov/articles/PMC13232160/> | "Association Between Individual Functional Movement Screen"

- physiology | <https://pmc.ncbi.nlm.nih.gov/articles/PMC13232160/> | "The total FMS™ score (≤ 14) was not significantly associated with injury (AUC = 0.52)"
- actionable | <https://pmc.ncbi.nlm.nih.gov/articles/PMC13232160/> | "Individual task scores, particularly the DS and HS, were more predictive of injury than the total"

Sources:

- <https://pmc.ncbi.nlm.nih.gov/articles/PMC13232160/>
- <https://doi.org/10.26603/001c.162342>

Reference

Runner-up topics

- Cliff Wilson on the Flex Diet Podcast: coach to the athlete's skill level, "people trying to dunk when they don't even know how to dribble." Strong hot take on HS athletes chasing advanced methods before they own the basics. Needs a research anchor.
- Loaded change-of-direction training in U19 players (PMC12533869): adding external load to COD drills and what transfers to sprint and repeated-sprint ability.
- Rest-pause versus drop sets for progressive overload (PMC13292392): in-season time efficiency angle for athletes with 30 minutes in the weight room.

Sources scanned today

- Newsletter digest /Users/larsstevenson/Cowork/newsletter-digest/output/newsletter_digest_2026-07-29.pdf — 2 sources. Mercola sleep item was pure promo

(skipped). Mike T. Nelson / Flex Diet Podcast with Cliff Wilson had one usable idea (coaching to skill level: "I see some people trying to dunk when they don't even know how to dribble") — held as a runner-up, no primary research behind it.

- Europe PMC, athlete-filtered queries for July 2026 open-access publications (titles: athletes, sprint, soccer, football, hamstring, resistance training, lacrosse). 6 hits; the Gaelic football hamstring paper was the standout.
- Europe PMC, functional movement screen + injury prediction, sorted newest. 28 hits; the June 2026 IJSPT prospective cohort is the freshest primary.
- Web scan: change-of-direction / SAQ training in adolescent team sport, cold water immersion and training adaptation, BJSM / JOSPT youth injury prevention.
- Rejected as repeats after checking cited-sources.json and Clinical-Brain/Research-Inbox/: the cold water immersion hypertrophy meta-analysis (PMC11235606, already

cited 2026-05-27 and 2026-06-29), and the SAQ change-of-direction meta-analysis (already filed as saq-training-change-of-direction-team-sport).

- Reddit r/AdvancedFitness and podcast show notes beyond the digest were not reached this run.